Types of Neurones

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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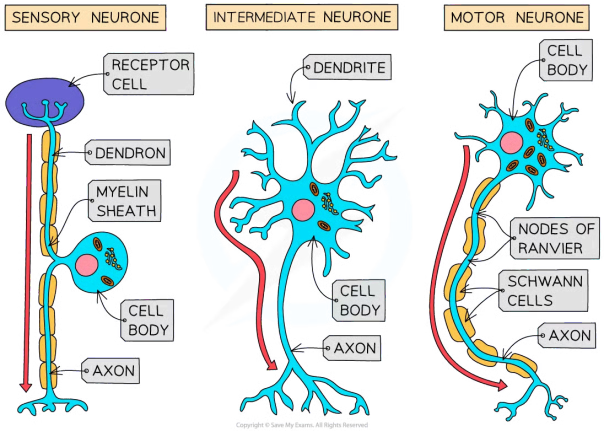
Updated on 25 September 2024

Neurone Diagrams

- There are three main types of neurone: **sensory, relay and motor**
  - **Sensory** neurones carry impulses **from sense organs to the CNS** (brain or spinal cord)
  - **Relay** neurones (also known as intermediate neurones) are found inside the CNS and **connect sensory and motor neurones**
  - **Motor** neurones carry impulses **from the CNS to effectors** (muscles or glands)

- Neurones have a long fibre (**axon**)
- This means that less time is wasted transferring the impulse from one cell to another
- The axon is insulated by a fatty sheath with small uninsulated sections along it (called nodes)
- This means that the electrical impulse does not travel down the whole axon, but **jumps from one node to the next**
- Their cell body contains many extensions called **dendrites**
- This means they can **connect to many other neurones** and receive impulses from them, forming a network for easy communication

Identifying the types of neurone:



The three types of neurone

- Sensory neurones are **long** and have a **cell body branching off the middle of the axon**

Help me understand

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

end with long dendrites branching off it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

A way to remember which neurone is which:

Sensory neurones connect a sense organ eg. eye, nose, tastebuds to the CNS

Motor neurones result in a response, which is often movement; think of a moving motorbike

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